AI Translator Guide

Converting raw country livestock data into the input template

CIAT / CGIAR Alliance, ClimateActionNetZero

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This page describes what the in-app AI translator does, how to use it for a single inventory, and how access is granted to non-CGIAR email addresses. It complements the user guide and the methodology document with a step-by-step walk-through of the translator workflow.

1 What the AI translator is for

The Cattle Uncertainty App expects its data in a specific Excel template: three sheets (Inventory_Metadata, Parameters, Manure_Management), with controlled vocabularies for sub-categories and manure-management systems, and a fixed column order. Real national inventory data rarely arrives in that shape: column names differ, units may be in litres instead of kilograms, sub-category labels reflect local practice ("Local breed adult cows", "draught oxen"), and uncertainty bounds are sometimes reported as a mean ± standard deviation rather than as an explicit 95% confidence interval.

The AI translator converts raw inventory data, in whatever shape it arrives, into the exact template the tool needs. The user uploads an Excel or CSV file (multi-sheet is supported), answers a small number of clarification questions in natural language, and downloads a filled template ready to upload to the Data Input tab.

The translator does column mapping and unit conversion. It does not do the emissions calculation itself; that happens after the filled template is uploaded.

2 What the translator will ask, and what it works out for itself

There is nothing to prepare and no form to fill in. The user uploads the file, with a note about it if there is something the AI should know, and answers the questions as they arrive. The AI's reply appears as a bubble (the full text behind "Show full reply"); a second bubble says that the questions will come one at a time; then each question is its own bubble, answered in the normal input box with Send. The answers stay on the page until the last one, then go back to the AI in one message, so the AI reflects on all of them at once. "skip" leaves a question to the IPCC default. If the reflection raises new questions, the same thing happens again.

Every answer becomes a recorded decision, and a short line in the conversation says what your answers settled ("Recorded: Inventory year: 2022"). A wrong line is corrected by replying. What the AI read from the file or assumed is listed in the checks workbook. The decisions are sent to the AI with every emission call as binding, they override the file and the defaults, and the finished rows are checked against them: a production system that contradicts one is re-emitted once with the decision quoted, and if it still contradicts, the decision is listed as not applied above the download.

When **Produce template now** is pressed, what can be assumed is assumed and said in one line (the species as mapped from the file, the IPCC edition as in the file, all production systems kept, manure shares from the

file where present, the file's ranges where given), and only what cannot be assumed is asked: the inventory year if nothing has settled it, and any column where the header says percent while the values look like fractions. Calves are never asked about: one source category becomes one template category, so a single calves row stays one group. After the last answer the pop-up asks where the files should go, and the template starts from there.

The country name and the inventory year are also required, and are quick to state if they are not in the file.

3 One inventory per conversation

Each finished template describes one country and one inventory year, because the Inventory_Metadata sheet carries a single country field. Two inventories therefore need two templates, two conversations and two runs of the tool.

Start a new conversation for the second inventory rather than continuing the first. A conversation carries the sub-category vocabulary, unit conventions and manure system mapping agreed for the inventory already in it, and those are exactly the things that can be carried across to the next one without anyone noticing: the resulting template is still well formed, and the error is only visible by comparing it against the source file.

Two people working on different inventories at the same time should also expect the panel to feel slower than it does for one person alone, because the app serves everyone from a single process. The translation itself is unaffected, but replies queue behind each other. Where several inventories are being prepared in one session, it is worth staggering the work rather than starting every translation at once.

4 Large files and fine geography

Two separate limits apply, and they catch different files. One is about the size of the file you upload, the other about how many groups the inventory describes. A file can pass one and fail the other.

4.1 The upload limit

The panel accepts `.xlsx`, `.xlsm`, `.xls` and `.csv`, up to **8 MB**. A larger file is refused by the browser before it reaches the tool, with a message saying so.

National calculator workbooks are often well over this, and usually for reasons that have nothing to do with the inventory: feed composition tables, municipality lookups, macros and embedded charts. The fix is to copy the sheets that actually hold the cattle data into a new workbook and upload that. It is normal for a 20 MB national calculator to become a 200 KB file with two sheets in it.

4.2 The conversation limit

Even inside 8 MB, a file can hold more data than the conversation can carry. The panel shows an estimated token count for each sheet before anything is sent, and warns if the total is too large. Untick the sheets the translator does not need: reference tables, vocabulary lists, calculation sheets whose results already appear elsewhere.

Nothing is charged until you press send, so a warning at this stage costs nothing to act on.

4.3 The group limit

The tool simulates about **400 groups**, where a group is one combination of `cattle_type`, `aggregation_level` and `sub_category`. An inventory with 1,121 municipalities and 9 animal sub-categories is roughly 10,000 groups, which no amount of translating will make runnable.

Decide the geographic level before you translate, not after. Translating at municipality level and aggregating afterwards wastes the translation, because the aggregation has to happen in the source data and the file then has to be translated again.

The translator is told about this limit and should raise the question itself, as the first item in its list of ambiguities, when your file carries more than one geographic level. If it does not raise it, raise it yourself: tell it which level to use, in the same message where you answer its other questions.

4.4 Where the aggregation happens

In your own data, before you upload. Most national calculators already contain the coarser level: a department total row alongside the municipality rows. If yours does, point the translator at those rows and ignore the rest.

If it does not, aggregate before uploading: add the populations together, and take population-weighted averages of every other parameter. The user guide describes this under "How many groups the tool can run", along with the reason that splitting a large inventory into several runs and combining the results afterwards gives the wrong confidence interval.

5 The three-step workflow

The translator works in three explicit passes: Explore, Clarify, Emit, rather than attempting all three at once. This separation prevents the AI from silently dropping rows or substituting catalogue defaults for values the user supplied.

5.1 Step 1: Explore

After the file is read, the panel lists its sheets with their size and lets the user untick reference or lookup sheets the AI does not need before sending; fewer sheets mean a faster first reply and a cheaper run. The AI's first response is then a structured exploration report with four labelled sections:

- **A. File shape.** For each sheet in the upload, the AI classifies the layout pattern (column-oriented, wide-stacked, parameter-labelled, reference-table, or calc-sheet).
- **B. Inventory of values found.** A table listing every (parameter, sub-category) pair the AI could identify in the file, with the source sheet, row, column, central value, lower and upper bounds where present, units, and any qualifier (such as "Local breed only" or "Cross breed weighted average").
- **C. Inventory of gaps.** IPCC catalogue parameters that the file does not provide. These will need to be filled with IPCC defaults at emission time.
- **D. Ambiguities to resolve.** Questions the user must answer before the template can be produced: sub-category vocabulary mapping, unit conversions, biological zeros, manure-management code interpretation, breed disaggregation, and similar.

The exploration report is the persistent ground-truth artefact that drives the rest of the workflow. The user is expected to read it carefully: section B in particular should list every parameter present in the source file. A parameter missing from section B should be raised in the chat before proceeding.

5.2 Step 2: Clarify

The user answers the questions in section D in plain natural-language chat messages. There is no required template for the answers; the AI parses them and updates its internal mapping. Typical clarifications include:

- Sub-category vocabulary mapping (e.g., "Cows" → `other_cows`; "Adult males" → `bulls`). One source category becomes one template category: a single calves row in the file becomes the pooled `calves` code, never a male and female split the file does not make.
- Unit conversions (litres of milk to kilograms using the cow-milk density 1.03 kg/L; digestibility expressed as a fraction 0.55 versus a percentage 55%).

- Biological zeros (Milk = 0 for non-lactating sub-categories; hours of work = 0 for non-oxen).
- Manure-management code interpretation (e.g., a file-level "PIT" entry → `liquid_slurry`; "DL" → `dry_lot`).
- Whether the file's mean ± SD reporting should be converted to mean ± 1.96 · SD for the 95% confidence interval.

If the user wants to add data that is not in the file (typically national population numbers), the values can be typed directly into the chat. They will be incorporated into the final template alongside the file-derived values.

Revising a produced template. After a template has been produced, the link **Back to the conversation** keeps the answers and the history, and a change can be typed as a reply. In that revision, and only there, a button **Upload a past translation** sits above the reply box: a template produced by the tool, corrected in Excel and uploaded there is read next to the source file, which stays in the conversation. The checks are run on it at once, a note box carries the user's comments into the chat, and the AI is told that this is a past translation whose values outrank the original file and the earlier answers. Pressing **Produce template now** then builds the template from the corrected values.

5.3 Step 3: Emit

When the section D questions are answered, the user clicks **Produce template now**. The AI translates section B (file-derived values), section C (catalogue gaps to be filled with IPCC defaults), and the biological zeros confirmed in section D, mechanically, into the JSON template, one production system at a time.

The run is a job the page does not have to stay open for. A progress bar shows the system being produced, the time elapsed and an estimate of the time left (from the size of each system and the speed of earlier runs). When the files are ready they are delivered by themselves: with **Choose where to save** pressed beforehand (Chrome and Edge), all three files are written into that folder; otherwise the data workbook downloads by itself and the other two files get a button. If the page was closed before the end, the three files are emailed to the signed-in address, and they also stay in the app until the server restarts.

Three files come out of a translation, named after the country, the inventory year and the time: the **data workbook** (the template, with a filter on every column, flagged cells coloured red, orange or blue, and a Check and a Why column at the right of each sheet), the **checks workbook** (every point to review, failures first, with a column to record what was decided, plus the decisions and a summary), and the **conversation document** (the questions and the answers, raw).

Above the buttons sits a **quality preview**: the same checks the QA/QC tab will run after upload (pass, warn and fail counts with the failing rows) plus every consistency note that compares rows with each other and with the source file. The notes name the places where a translation typically goes wrong: a source category missing from the template (every category of the file must be a group unless a merge was agreed), a value in the Parameters sheet that differs from the time series for the inventory year, a percentage written as a fraction or the reverse, a population counted under two groups, a value tagged as read from the file that the file does not contain, manure shares that do not sum to 100 %, one manure system given different coefficients in different production systems, and a range or a distribution the file did not give and the IPCC catalogue supplied. Each note is a sentence to check against the source file. The user can go back to the conversation and correct, or download and deal with the points in the checks workbook and on the QA/QC tab.

The downloaded file follows the official template format exactly. After download, the user should open the file and skim the `data_source` column of the Parameters sheet to confirm that values from the source file are tagged `user_file`, IPCC catalogue values are tagged `ipcc_default`, and explicit zero values are tagged `biological_zero` or `placeholder`. This is the recommended spot-check for catching translation failures before the simulation runs.

6 Getting access

The translator is gated behind a magic-link sign-in flow. Every address requires one-time manual approval by the administrator, including CGIAR addresses. Each translation is billed to the project, so access is granted by name rather than by domain. Approval is needed once; after that the browser stays signed in. The full sequence is as follows.

6.1 Initial request (first sign-in)

1. Open the **Resources tab** of the Cattle Uncertainty App and locate the AI Translator card (the first item, identified by the green left-edge accent).
2. Enter the email address into the sign-in field and click **Send sign-in link**.
3. Within 1–2 minutes, an email arrives from `noreply@cattle-uncertainty.app` with subject "Sign in to the IPCC Cattle GHG Uncertainty tool". The link in it stays valid for 30 days and may be clicked more than once; after the first successful click the browser stays signed in, so the link is only needed once per browser.
4. Click the link. The app opens in a browser tab and recognises that the email is not yet approved. A confirmation message is displayed:

   > Thanks: your request to access the AI translator (your.email@example.org) has been forwarded to the administrator for approval. You'll receive an email once approved.

   At the same moment, the administrator receives a notification email summarising the request (email address, timestamp).

6.2 Approval (administrator side)

5. The administrator reviews the request and, if appropriate, adds the email address to the approved-users list and redeploys the app. The administrator typically responds the same working day.
6. Once added, the user automatically receives a welcome email confirming approval. The email contains a direct link back to the app and a brief reminder of the workflow.

6.3 Subsequent sign-in (after approval)

7. Return to the AI Translator card on the Resources tab.
8. Enter the same email address again and click **Send sign-in link**. A fresh magic-link email arrives within 1–2 minutes.
9. Click the new link. The app verifies the email is now on the approved list, drops a long-lived sign-in cookie in the browser, and unlocks the chat panel.
10. On subsequent visits from the same browser, the cookie keeps the user signed in. No additional magic-link step is required unless the user clears site data or switches browsers.

6.4 Staying signed in

The app remembers you in the browser you signed in with. A different browser or machine, or clearing your site data, means asking for a new sign-in link. A private or incognito window forgets everything when you close it, so it needs a new link every time. Use a normal window, especially if sign-in emails are slow to reach you.

Your conversation is safe either way. It is saved against your email address, not in the browser, so it comes back when you sign in again.

7 When to use the translator and when to skip it

The AI translator is intended for the common case in which raw inventory data does not match the tool's template. It is most useful when:

- The user's data is in a non-standard shape (multi-sheet workbook with section headers, form-style layout, free-text comments interspersed with values).
- Column names differ from the template (e.g., `cattle_pop` instead of `N`, `live_wt_lb` instead of `BW`).
- Units are inconsistent (mix of kg and lb, fractions and percentages, litres and kilograms of milk).
- IPCC defaults are needed for parameters the user does not measure.

The translator is not required when the user already has a filled template: in that case, upload directly via the Data Input tab. The translator is also not the appropriate tool for converting an emissions-calculation result; it works on input parameters only.

8 Quality control and limitations

The translator performs column mapping and unit conversion. It does not validate the underlying values against external reference data, and it cannot detect systematic errors in the source file (e.g., a transcription mistake in the original survey). Two checks are recommended after every translation:

- **Read the quality preview before downloading.** It lists the checks that will fail after upload and the consistency notes described under Step 3. On the first real translation (a 27-group national inventory) every error the AI had introduced appeared in that list.
- **Spot-check the key numbers.** Compare population, body weight, and milk yield in the downloaded template against the corresponding cells in the source file. Any discrepancy indicates a translation error to be raised in the chat.
- **Review the QA/QC tab after upload.** Any value the translator filled from an IPCC default is flagged with `data_source = "ipcc_default"` in the QA tab, allowing the user to review whether the catalogue default is appropriate for the country context. For body weight (`BW`), the QA tab also runs a continental-default deviation check (Annex Tables 10A.1 / 10A.2 / 10A.3) and warns on deviations larger than ±50%.
- **The workbook records its provenance.** The Notes cell of `Inventory_Metadata` carries the app version, a fingerprint of the instructions the AI worked from, a fingerprint of the IPCC defaults table, the model, and the date, so a file that comes back for support can be traced to the defaults it was built with.
- **Resumed conversations are checked against the current defaults.** If the IPCC defaults or the template changed since a saved conversation was held, the panel says so and asks for the file to be uploaded again before a template can be produced; the earlier discussion would otherwise carry the old numbers into the workbook.

9 Privacy and operational cost

9.1 Where your data goes

When a file is uploaded, its contents are sent to the AI service over an encrypted connection. That is how the translation is done, and it is the main thing to be aware of before uploading anything.

A copy of the conversation, including the uploaded data and the user's email address, is then written to a file on the app server. It is kept so that a user can close the tab and resume where they left off. It is removed in two cases: when the user clicks **Reset conversation**, or when the server restarts after a period without use. There is no scheduled deletion beyond that, so **Reset conversation is the reliable way to remove it**.

Separately, a usage log records the date, the user's email address, the model and the token count of each call. It holds no file contents and exists so the administrator can monitor spending.

The AI service applies its own terms to the data it receives. Those terms are the service provider's and should be consulted directly rather than summarised here.

9.2 Cost

The translator is hosted by the GMH project on a dedicated AI service account, and the user is not billed for usage. A monthly global spending cap is in place; if the cap is reached, an explicit "monthly cap reached, contact administrator" message is shown and translation requests pause until the next cycle.

9.3 Whether to use it at all

The IPCC inventory data the translator handles is generally non-sensitive (it is destined for UNFCCC reporting, which is a public-record process). For ministries with internal policies restricting upload of pre-publication data to external AI services, the translator should not be used; the template can instead be filled manually using the IPCC defaults provided in the user guide.

9.4 Related material

- User Guide, §"AI-assisted data preparation": the same workflow described in the printable user guide, including the non-CGIAR step-by-step.
- Methodology document: full equations, parameter definitions, and references for everything the translator outputs.
- Find out more: Correlations, the companion topic page covering the correlation modes on the Simulate tab.

Generated by scripts/build_help_docs.R from documentation/source/ai_translator.Rmd.

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This guide shows how to turn your own cattle data into the file the tool needs. The AI translator does this for you. You upload your file, answer a few questions, and download the finished template. Every step below has a picture of what you will see.

10 What the translator does

The tool needs its data in one Excel template with three sheets: Inventory_Metadata, Parameters and Manure_Management. Your own data is rarely in that shape. Column names differ. Milk may be in litres. Animal groups have local names. The translator reads your file, asks you about the parts it cannot work out on its own, and writes the template.

The translator only maps and converts your data. It does not calculate emissions. That happens after you upload the template on the Data Input tab.

11 Before you start

You need three things.

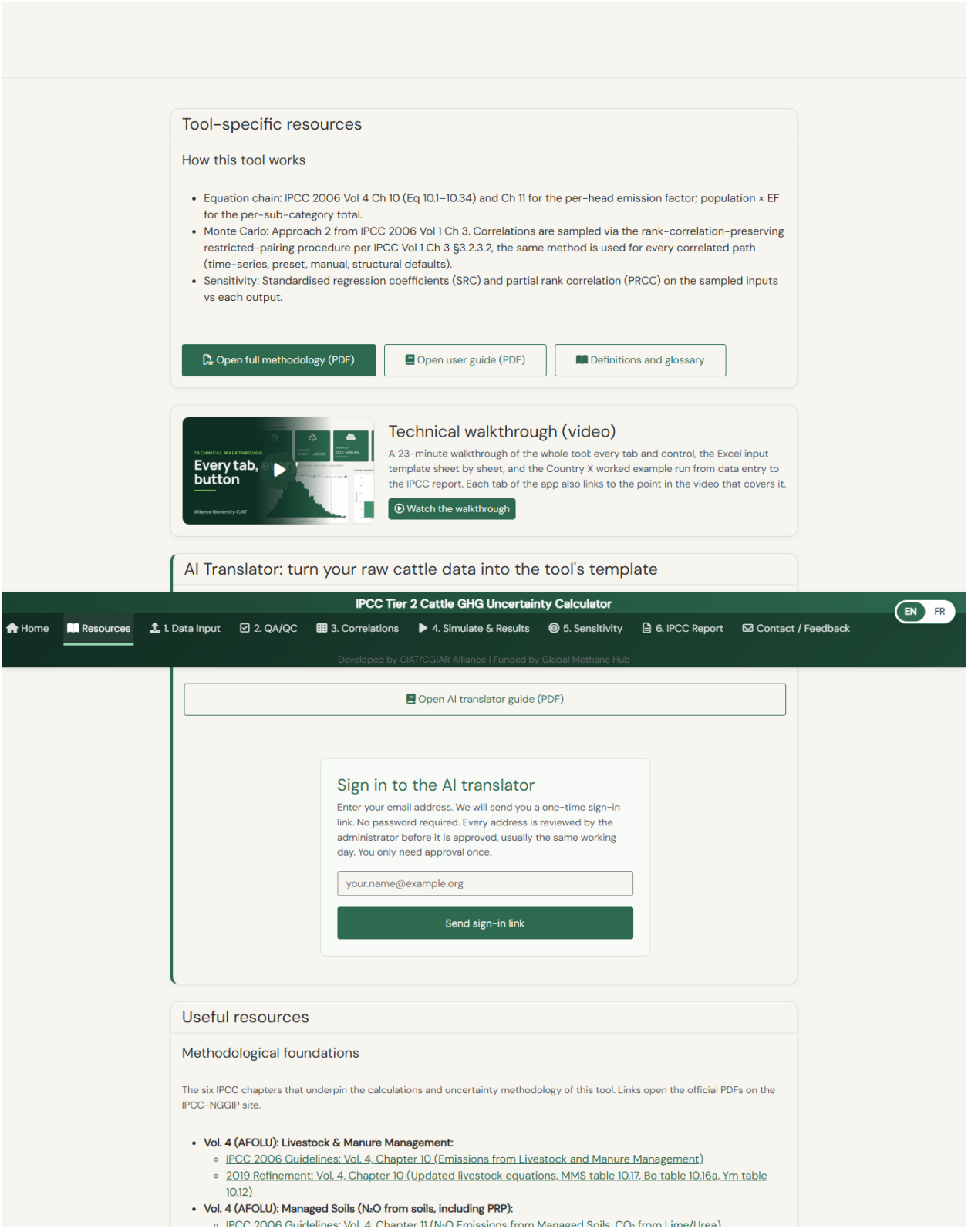
1. **Your data file.** An Excel file (.xlsx, .xlsm or .xls) or a .csv file, up to 8 MB. If your file is bigger, copy the sheets with the cattle data into a new workbook and upload that one. Reference tables, charts and macros are not needed.
2. **The country and the inventory year.** The translator will ask if they are not in the file.
3. **Access.** The translator needs a sign-in. The first time, your email address has to be approved. This is explained in the next section.

One more thing to decide before you upload: the geographic level. The tool can run about 400 groups, where a group is one combination of cattle type, production system and animal class. A file with 1,000

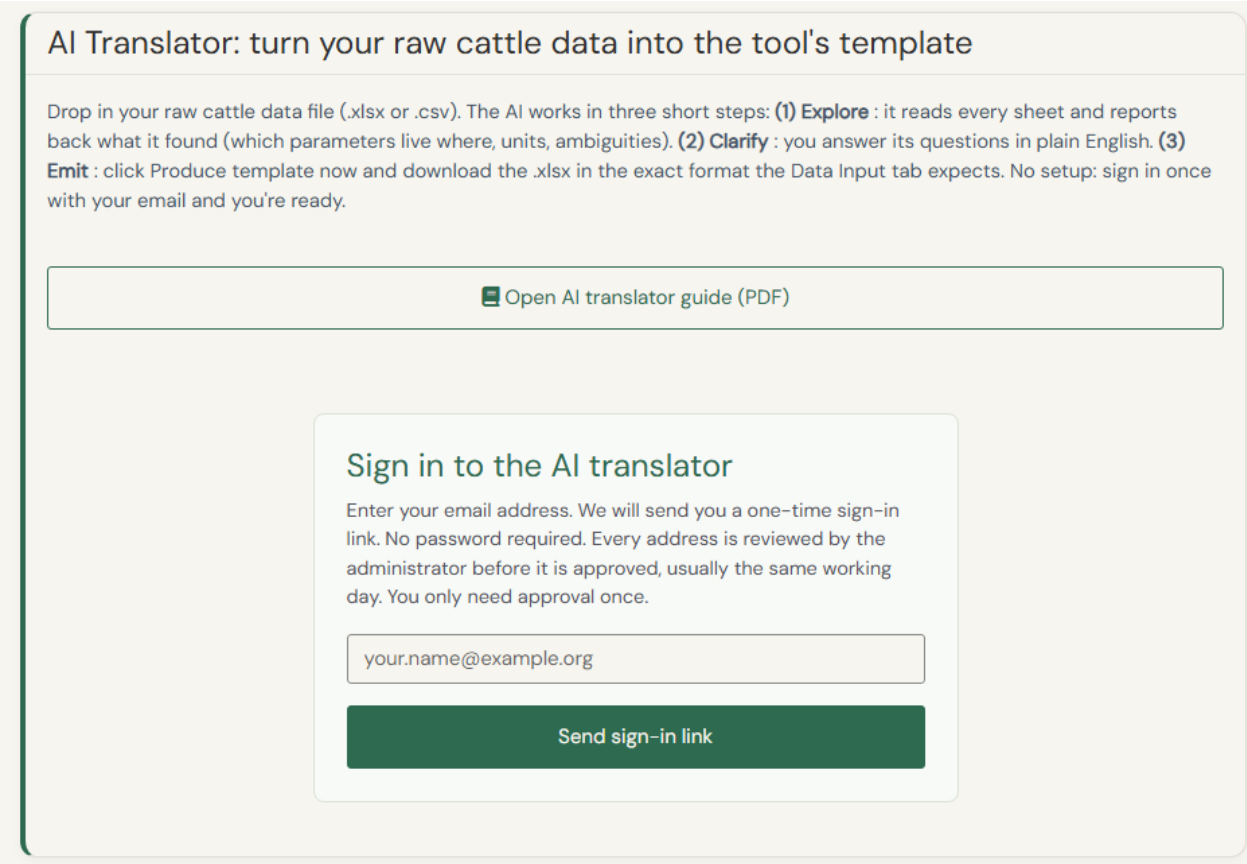
municipalities and 9 animal classes is 9,000 groups. That is too many. If your file has several levels, pick the national or regional rows before you upload, or tell the translator which level to use when it asks.

12 Step 1. Open the translator and sign in

Open the app and click the **Resources** tab. The translator is the card called “AI Translator: turn your raw cattle data into the tool’s template”.



The first time, you see a sign-in box. Type your email address and click **Send sign-in link**.

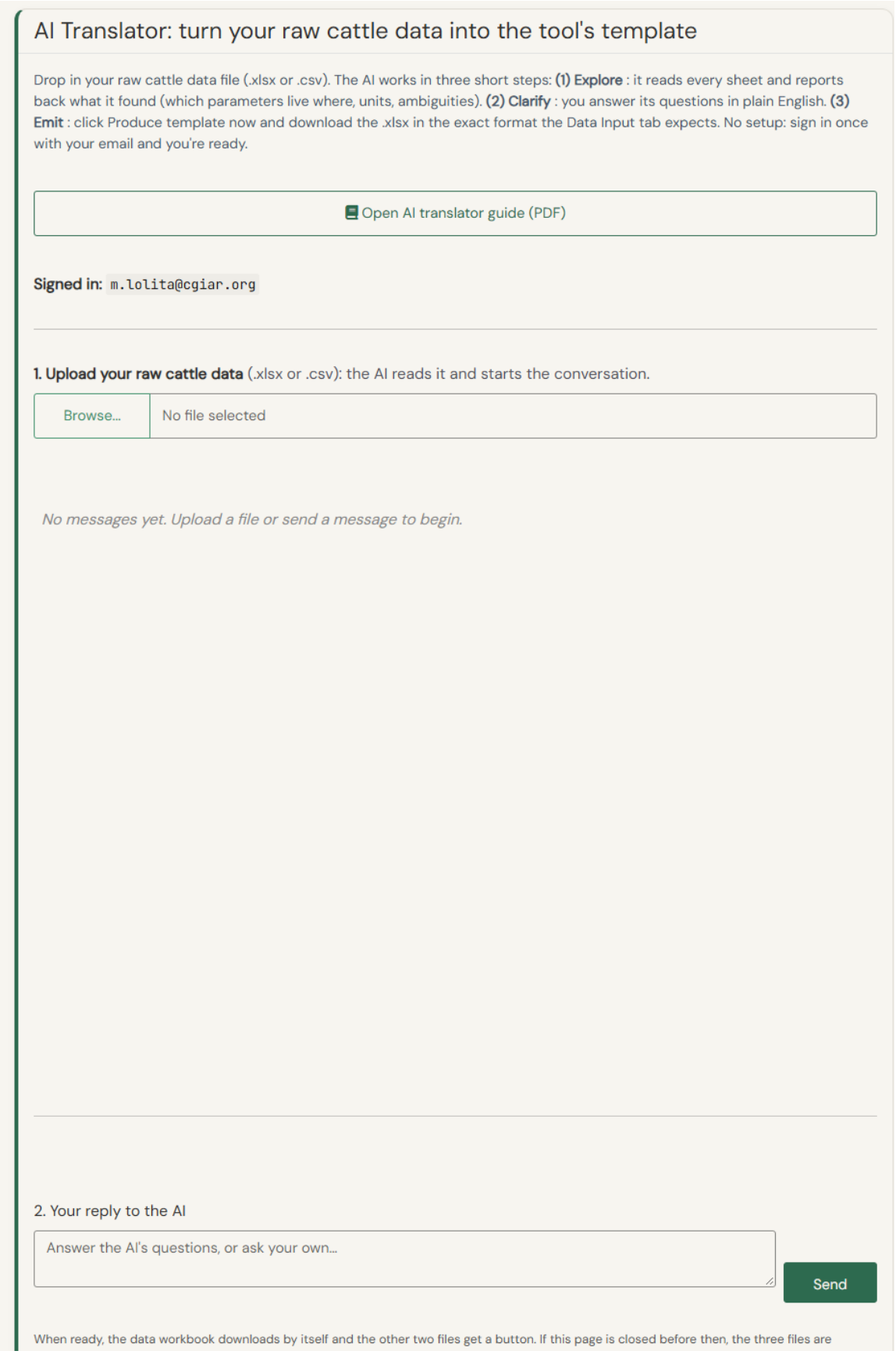


What happens next depends on whether your address is already approved.

First time (not yet approved). An email arrives within a minute or two. Click the link in it. The app opens and tells you that your request has been sent to the administrator. You get another email once you are approved, usually the same working day. Then come back, enter your email again, and click the new link.

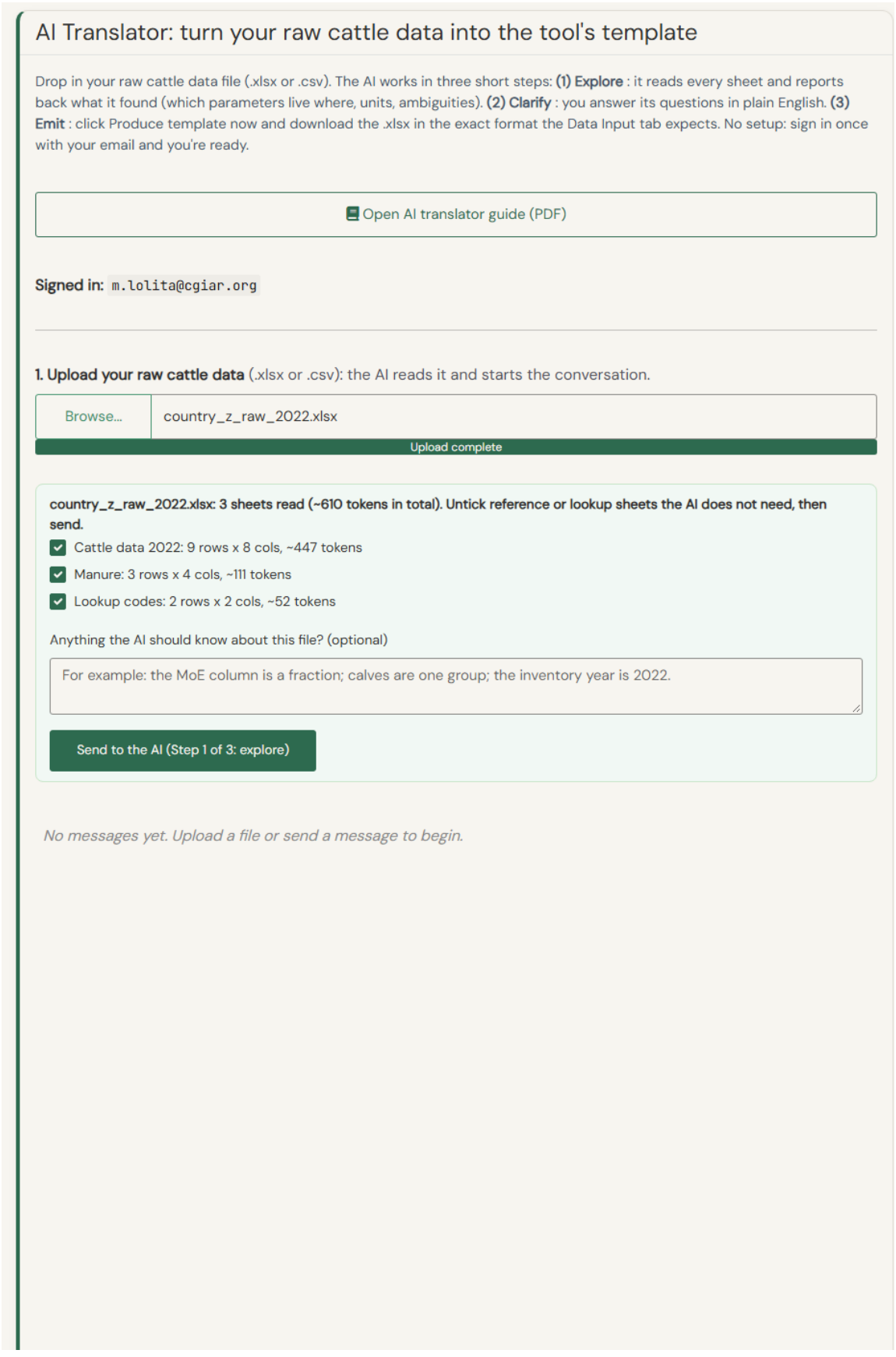
Already approved. Click the link in the email. The app opens with the translator unlocked, and your browser stays signed in. You do not need a new link next time, unless you use another browser or clear your browsing data. A private or incognito window forgets you every time, so use a normal window.

When you are signed in, the card shows your email and an upload box.


AI Translator: turn your raw cattle data into the tool's template
Drop in your raw cattle data file (.xlsx or .csv). The AI works in three short steps: (1) Explore : it reads every sheet and reports back what it found (which parameters live where, units, ambiguities). (2) Clarify : you answer its questions in plain English. (3) Emit : click Produce template now and download the .xlsx in the exact format the Data Input tab expects. No setup: sign in once with your email and you're ready.
Open AI translator guide (PDF)
Signed in: m.lolita@cgiar.org
1. Upload your raw cattle data (.xlsx or .csv): the AI reads it and starts the conversation.
Browse...
No file selected
No messages yet. Upload a file or send a message to begin.
2. Your reply to the AI
Answer the AI's questions, or ask your own...
Send
When ready, the data workbook downloads by itself and the other two files get a button. If this page is closed before then, the three files are

13 Step 2. Upload your file

Click **Browse** and pick your file. The translator reads it and lists the sheets it found, with a size for each one.


AI Translator: turn your raw cattle data into the tool's template
Drop in your raw cattle data file (.xlsx or .csv). The AI works in three short steps: (1) Explore : it reads every sheet and reports back what it found (which parameters live where, units, ambiguities). (2) Clarify : you answer its questions in plain English. (3) Emit : click Produce template now and download the .xlsx in the exact format the Data Input tab expects. No setup: sign in once with your email and you're ready.
Open AI translator guide (PDF)
Signed in: m.lolita@cgiar.org
1. Upload your raw cattle data (.xlsx or .csv): the AI reads it and starts the conversation.
Browse...
country_z_raw_2022.xlsx
Upload complete
country_z_raw_2022.xlsx: 3 sheets read (~610 tokens in total). Untick reference or lookup sheets the AI does not need, then send.
Cattle data 2022: 9 rows x 8 cols, ~447 tokens
Manure: 3 rows x 4 cols, ~111 tokens
Lookup codes: 2 rows x 2 cols, ~52 tokens
Anything the AI should know about this file? (optional)
For example: the MoE column is a fraction; calves are one group; the inventory year is 2022.
Send to the AI (Step 1 of 3: explore)
No messages yet. Upload a file or send a message to begin.

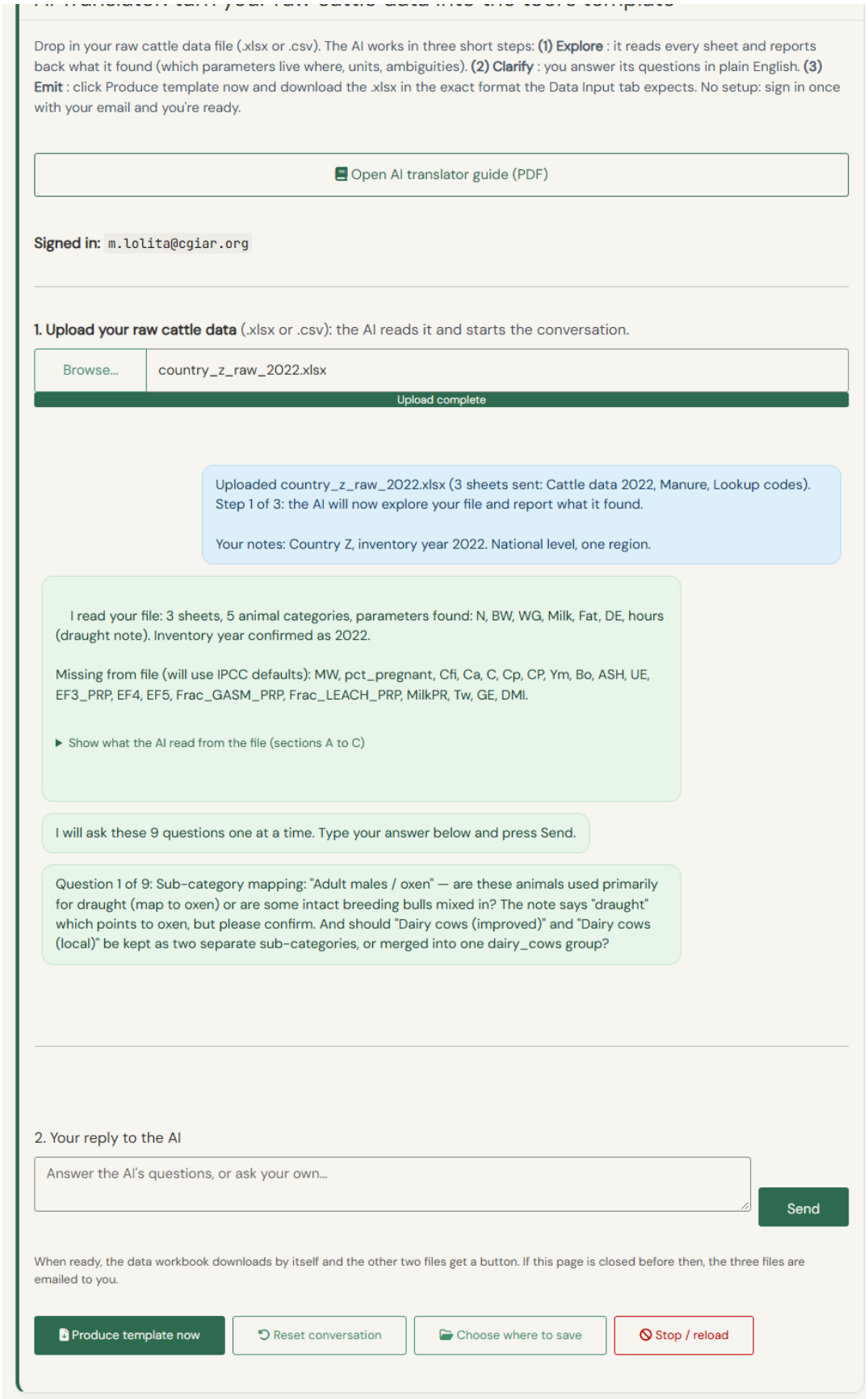
Untick the sheets the translator does not need, such as lookup tables or calculation sheets. Fewer sheets means a faster and cheaper first reply. If the total is too big for one conversation, a warning says so; untick more sheets.

There is a box for notes. Use it for anything the AI should know, for example “inventory year 2022, national level, milk is in litres”. It is optional.

Click **Send to the AI (Step 1 of 3: explore)**.

14 Step 3. Read what the AI found

After about a minute, the AI replies. The reply says which sheets, animal groups and parameters it found, and which parameters are missing from your file. Missing parameters are filled with IPCC default values later. Click **Show what the AI read from the file** to see the full list, with the sheet, row and column of every value.


Drop in your raw cattle data file (.xlsx or .csv). The AI works in three short steps: (1) Explore : it reads every sheet and reports back what it found (which parameters live where, units, ambiguities). (2) Clarify : you answer its questions in plain English. (3) Emit : click Produce template now and download the .xlsx in the exact format the Data Input tab expects. No setup: sign in once with your email and you're ready.
Open AI translator guide (PDF)
Signed in: m.lolita@cgiar.org
1. Upload your raw cattle data (.xlsx or .csv): the AI reads it and starts the conversation.
Browse...
country_z_raw_2022.xlsx
Upload complete
Uploaded country_z_raw_2022.xlsx (3 sheets sent: Cattle data 2022, Manure, Lookup codes). Step 1 of 3: the AI will now explore your file and report what it found.
Your notes: Country Z, inventory year 2022. National level, one region.
I read your file: 3 sheets, 5 animal categories, parameters found: N, BW, WG, Milk, Fat, DE, hours (draught note). Inventory year confirmed as 2022.
Missing from file (will use IPCC defaults): MW, pct_pregnant, Cfi, Ca, C, Cp, CP, Ym, Bo, ASH, UE, EF3_PRP, EF4, EF5, Frac_GASM_PRP, Frac_LEACH_PRP, MilkPR, Tw, GE, DMI.
Show what the AI read from the file (sections A to C)
I will ask these 9 questions one at a time. Type your answer below and press Send.
Question 1 of 9: Sub-category mapping: "Adult males / oxen" — are these animals used primarily for draught (map to oxen) or are some intact breeding bulls mixed in? The note says "draught" which points to oxen, but please confirm. And should "Dairy cows (improved)" and "Dairy cows (local)" be kept as two separate sub-categories, or merged into one dairy_cows group?
2. Your reply to the AI
Answer the AI's questions, or ask your own...
Send
When ready, the data workbook downloads by itself and the other two files get a button. If this page is closed before then, the three files are emailed to you.
Produce template now
Reset conversation
Choose where to save
Stop / reload

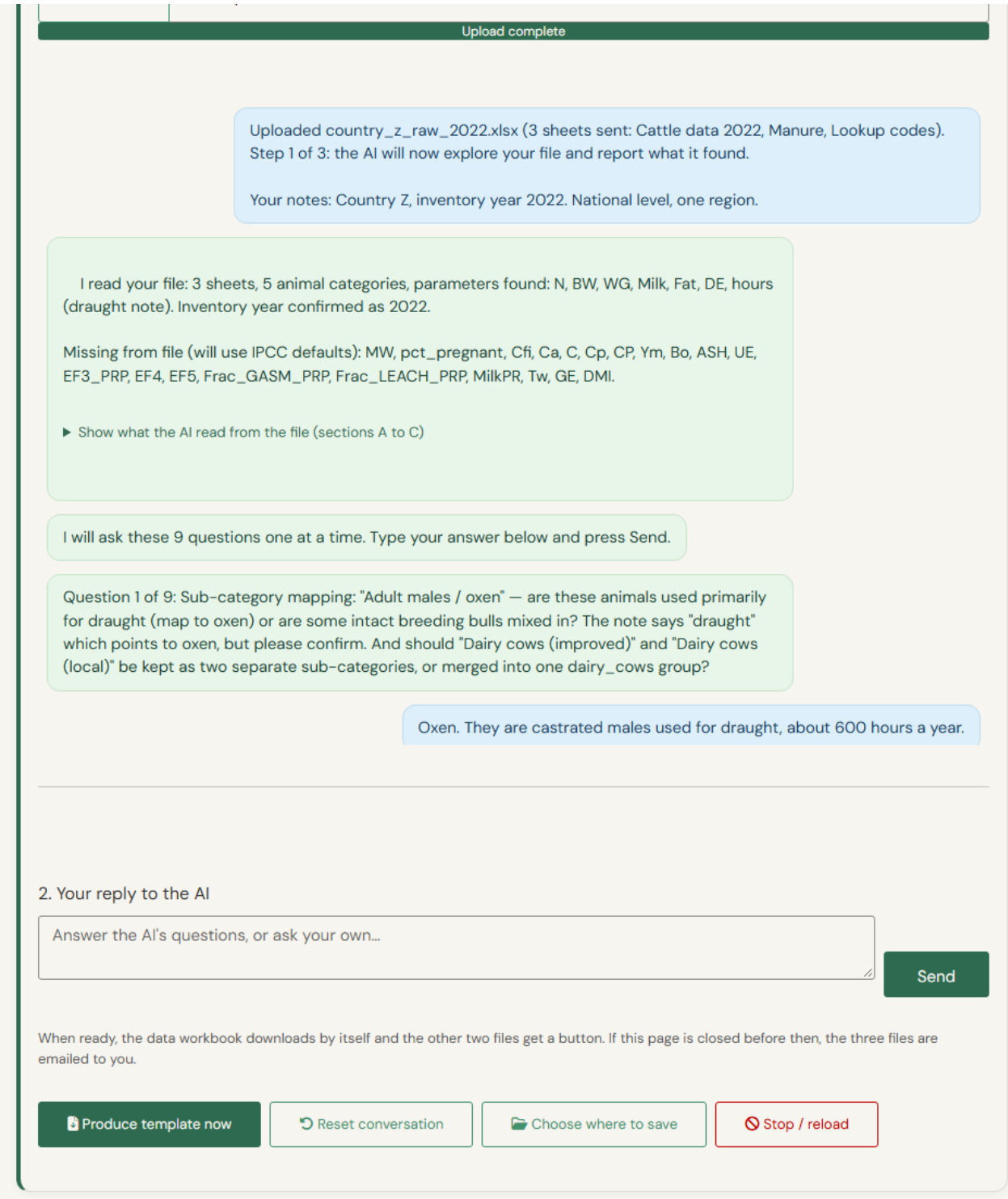
Check this list against your file. If a parameter you have is not in the list, say so in your next reply.

Below the list, the AI tells you how many questions it has, and asks the first one.

15 Step 4. Answer the questions

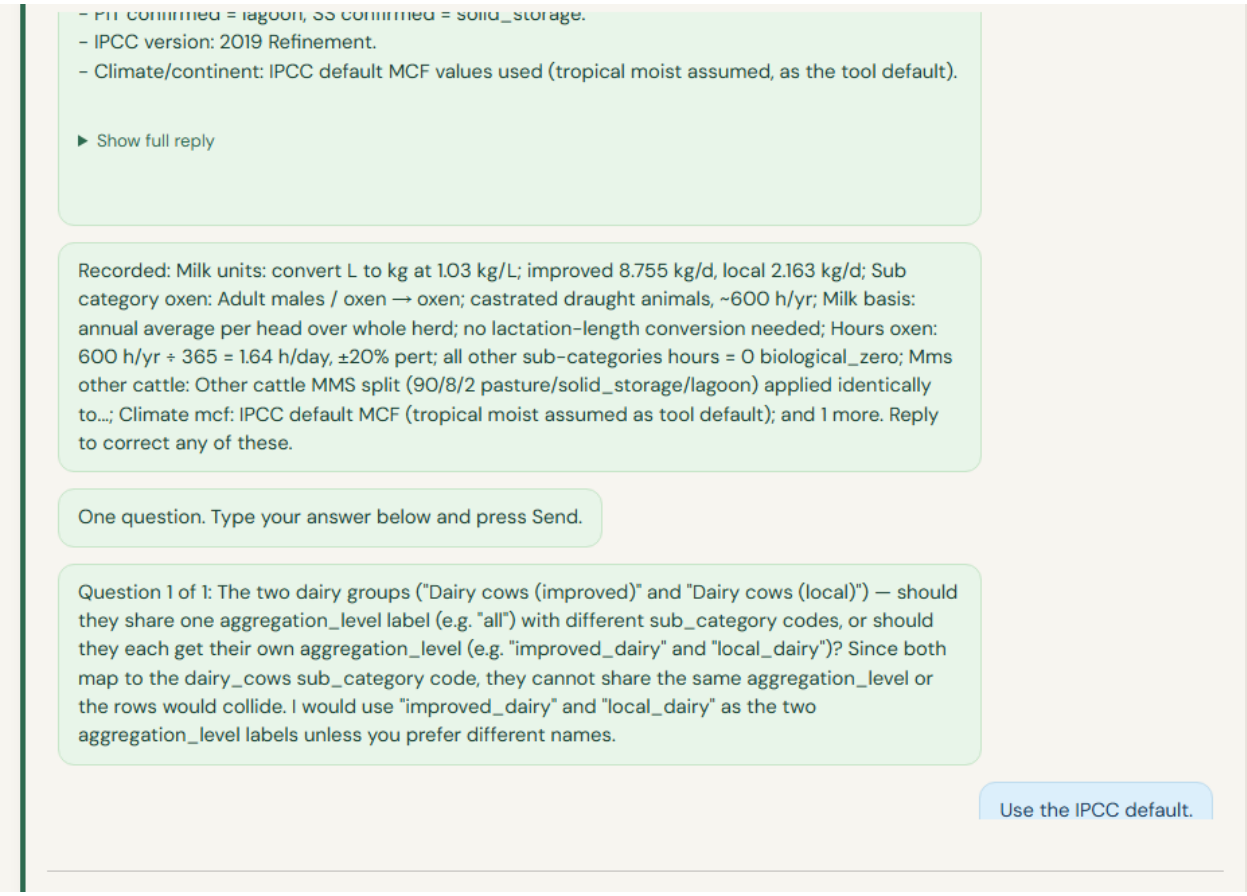
The questions come one at a time. Each one is about something the AI cannot decide alone: what a local group name means, whether a number is a percentage or a fraction, how to convert a unit, which manure system a code stands for.

Type your answer in the box under the chat and click **Send**. Plain language is fine, for example “Oxen. They are used for draught.” The next question appears.



If you do not know the answer, type “skip”. The AI then uses the IPCC default.

When the last question is answered, all your answers go back to the AI together. It replies with a short summary and a line starting with **Recorded:** for each decision it has taken from your answers. Read these lines. If one is wrong, reply with the correction.

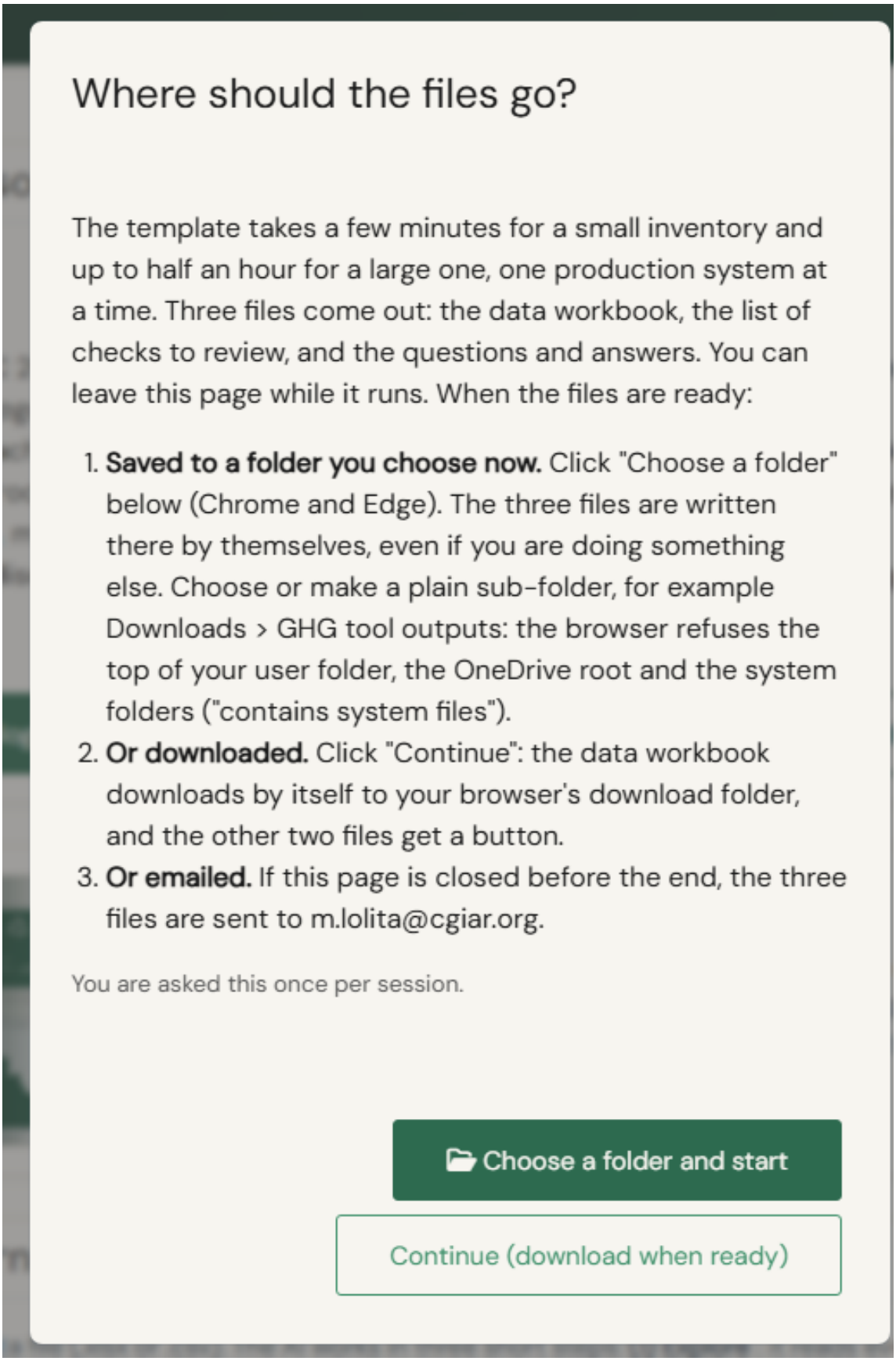


Sometimes the AI has new questions after reading your answers. Then the same thing happens again. When it has none, it says that everything is ready.

16 Step 5. Produce the template

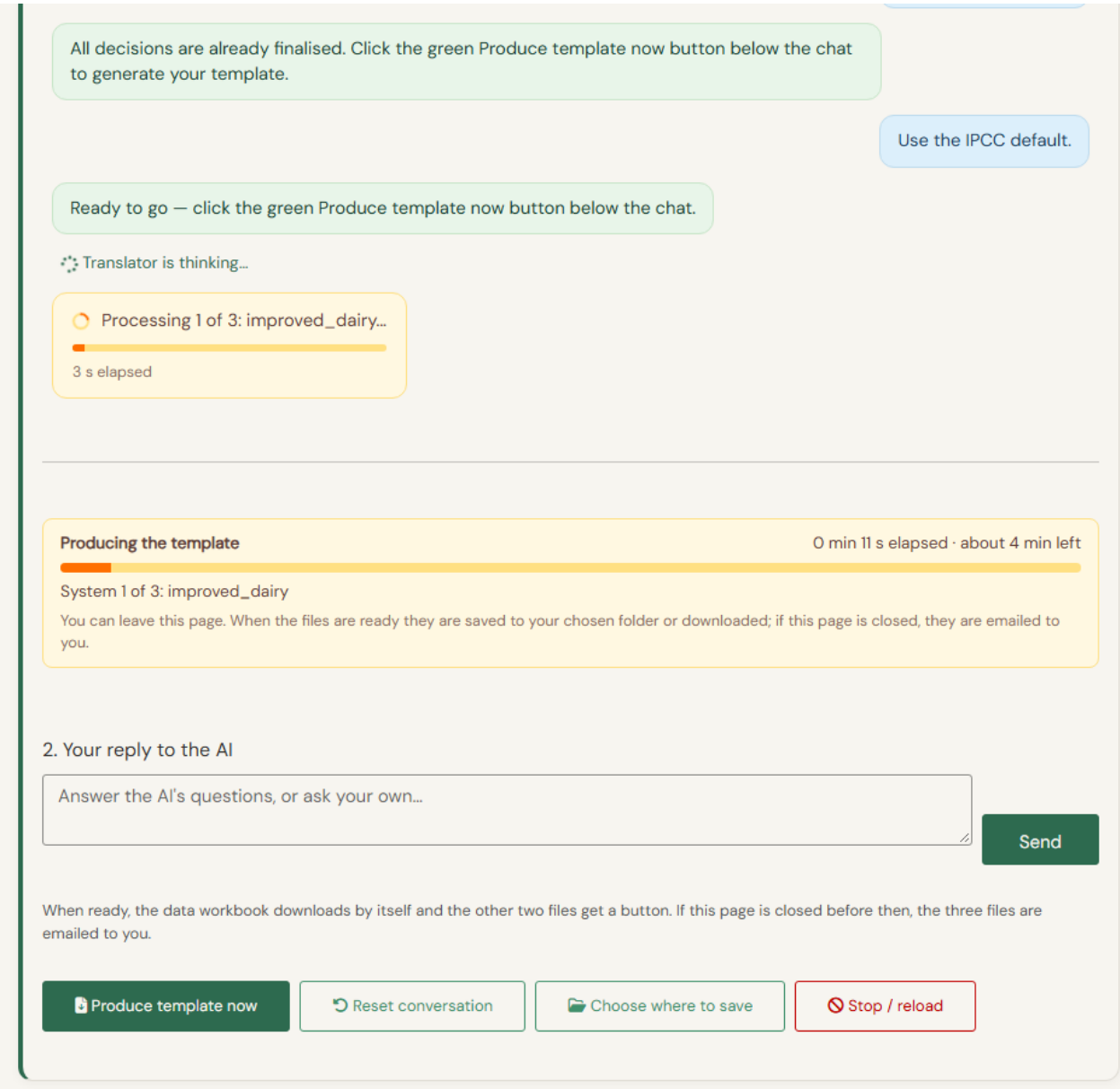
Click the green **Produce template now** button under the chat.

A pop-up asks where the files should go. You have three options.


Where should the files go?
The template takes a few minutes for a small inventory and up to half an hour for a large one, one production system at a time. Three files come out: the data workbook, the list of checks to review, and the questions and answers. You can leave this page while it runs. When the files are ready:
1. Saved to a folder you choose now. Click "Choose a folder" below (Chrome and Edge). The three files are written there by themselves, even if you are doing something else. Choose or make a plain sub-folder, for example Downloads > GHG tool outputs: the browser refuses the top of your user folder, the OneDrive root and the system folders ("contains system files").
2. Or downloaded. Click "Continue": the data workbook downloads by itself to your browser's download folder, and the other two files get a button.
3. Or emailed. If this page is closed before the end, the three files are sent to m.lolita@cgiar.org.
You are asked this once per session.
Choose a folder and start
Continue (download when ready)

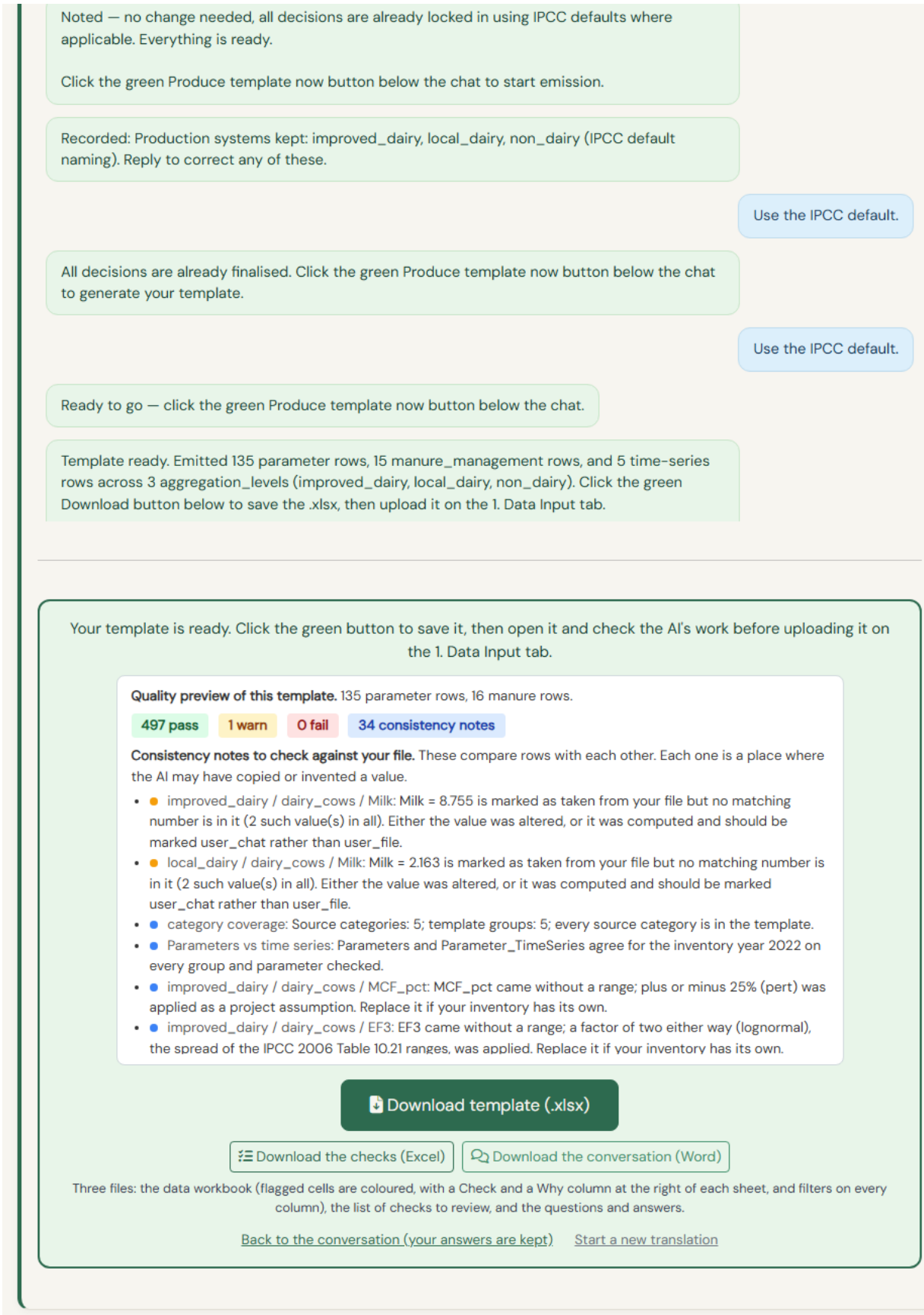
- **Choose a folder and start.** Works in Chrome and Edge. Pick a plain folder, for example a sub-folder of Downloads. The three files are written there when they are ready, even if you are doing something else.
- **Continue (download when ready).** The data workbook downloads by itself when it is ready. The other two files get a button.
- **Close the page.** If the page is closed before the end, the three files are emailed to the address you signed in with.

While the template is being produced, a progress bar shows which production system is being written and how much time is left. A small inventory takes a few minutes. A large one can take up to half an hour. You can leave the page.



17 Step 6. Check and download the files

When the work is done, the card shows a quality preview and three download buttons.


Noted — no change needed, all decisions are already locked in using IPCC defaults where applicable. Everything is ready.
Click the green Produce template now button below the chat to start emission.
Recorded: Production systems kept: improved_dairy, local_dairy, non_dairy (IPCC default naming). Reply to correct any of these.
Use the IPCC default.
All decisions are already finalised. Click the green Produce template now button below the chat to generate your template.
Use the IPCC default.
Ready to go — click the green Produce template now button below the chat.
Template ready. Emitted 135 parameter rows, 15 manure_management rows, and 5 time-series rows across 3 aggregation_levels (improved_dairy, local_dairy, non_dairy). Click the green Download button below to save the .xlsx, then upload it on the 1. Data Input tab.
Your template is ready. Click the green button to save it, then open it and check the AI's work before uploading it on the 1. Data Input tab.
Quality preview of this template. 135 parameter rows, 16 manure rows.
497 pass
1 warn
0 fail
34 consistency notes
Consistency notes to check against your file. These compare rows with each other. Each one is a place where the AI may have copied or invented a value.
improved_dairy / dairy_cows / Milk: Milk = 8.755 is marked as taken from your file but no matching number is in it (2 such value(s) in all). Either the value was altered, or it was computed and should be marked user_chat rather than user_file.
local_dairy / dairy_cows / Milk: Milk = 2.163 is marked as taken from your file but no matching number is in it (2 such value(s) in all). Either the value was altered, or it was computed and should be marked user_chat rather than user_file.
category coverage: Source categories: 5; template groups: 5; every source category is in the template.
Parameters vs time series: Parameters and Parameter_TimeSeries agree for the inventory year 2022 on every group and parameter checked.
improved_dairy / dairy_cows / MCF_pct: MCF_pct came without a range; plus or minus 25% (pert) was applied as a project assumption. Replace it if your inventory has its own.
improved_dairy / dairy_cows / EF3: EF3 came without a range; a factor of two either way (lognormal), the spread of the IPCC 2006 Table 10.21 ranges, was applied. Replace it if your inventory has its own.
Download template (.xlsx)
Download the checks (Excel)
Download the conversation (Word)
Three files: the data workbook (flagged cells are coloured, with a Check and a Why column at the right of each sheet, and filters on every column), the list of checks to review, and the questions and answers.
Back to the conversation (your answers are kept)
Start a new translation

The quality preview is the same set of checks the QA/QC tab will run after upload. It shows how many checks pass, warn or fail, and a list of consistency notes. Each note names a place where the AI may have changed or invented a value. Read them. If something is wrong, click **Back to the conversation** and tell the AI what to change. Then produce the template again.

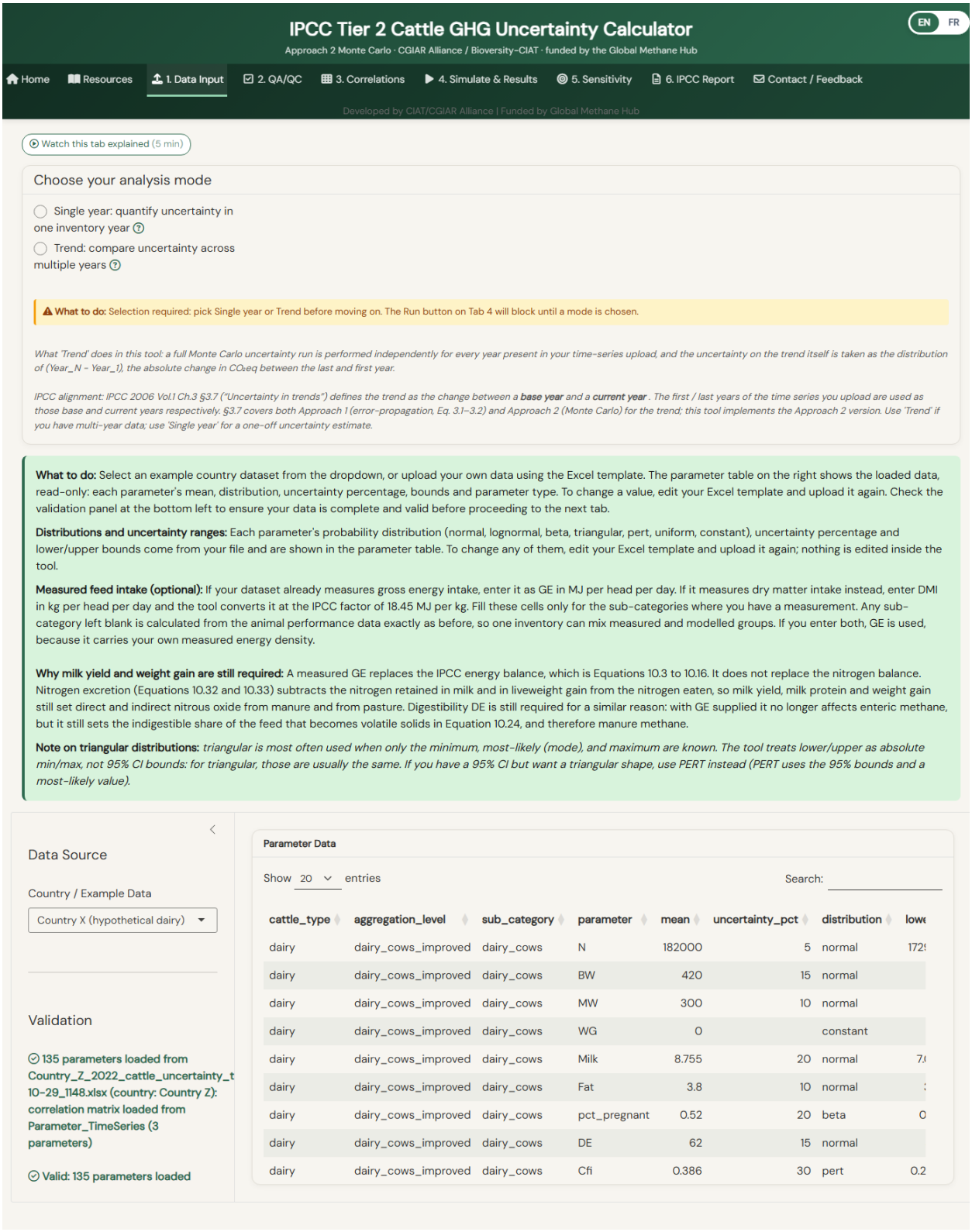
The three files are named after the country, the year and the time.

File	What it is	What to do with it
Data workbook (.xlsx)	The filled template. Cells with a flag are coloured. Each sheet has a Check and a Why column at the right.	Upload it on the Data Input tab.
Checks (.xlsx)	Every point to review, failures first, with a column for your decision.	Work through it and keep it with your inventory records.
Conversation (.docx)	The questions and your answers.	Keep it as the record of what was decided.

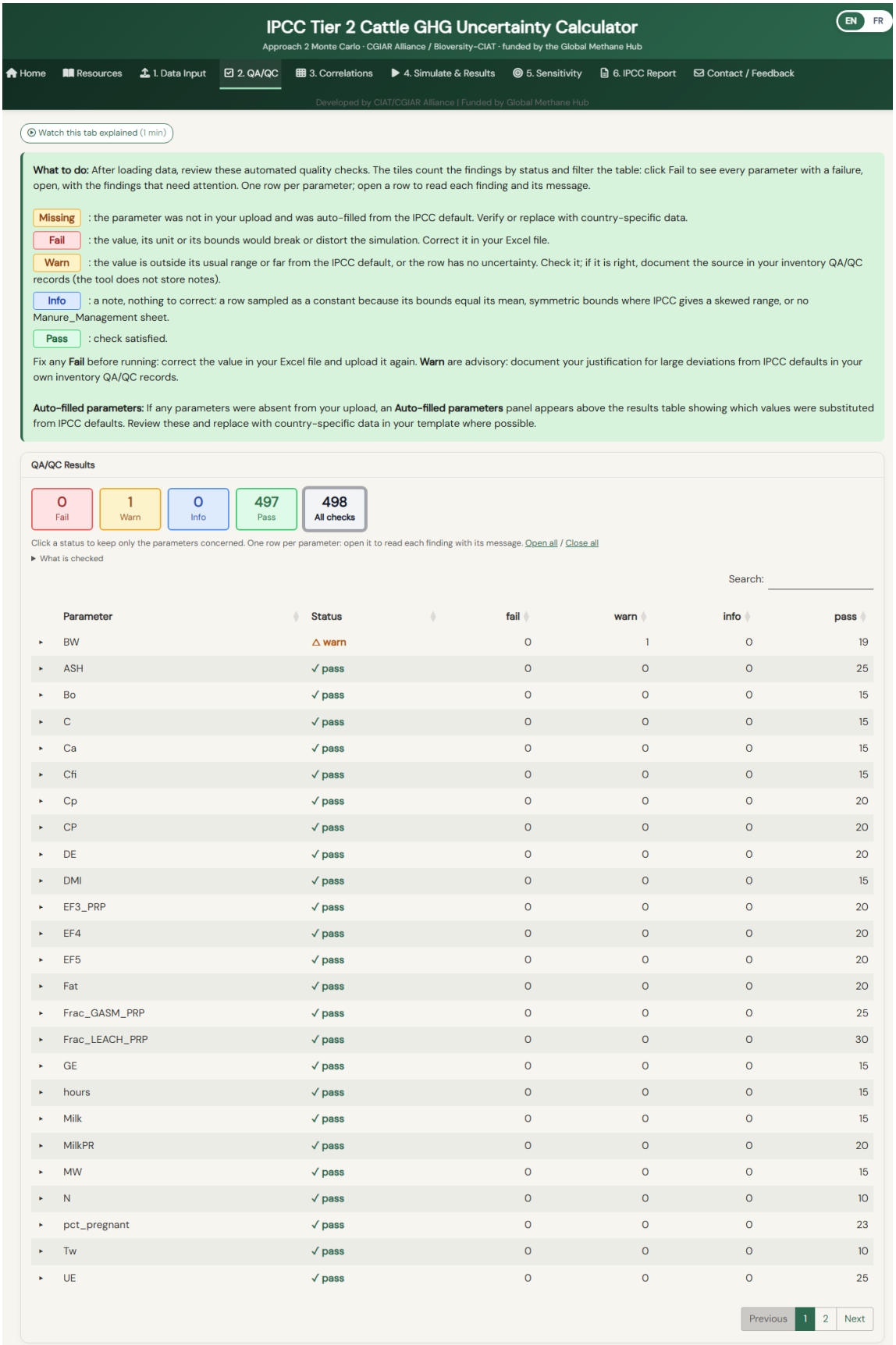
Before you upload the data workbook, open it and look at the `data_source` column of the Parameters sheet. Values from your file are marked `user_file`. Values from the IPCC defaults are marked `ipcc_default`. Zeros that are correct for biological reasons, like milk for oxen, are marked `biological_zero`. Compare a few key numbers, such as population, body weight and milk yield, with your original file.

18 Step 7. Upload the template in the tool

Go to the **1. Data Input** tab, choose **Single year** or **Trend**, and upload the data workbook.



Then open the **2. QA/QC** tab. Every value the translator filled from an IPCC default is listed there, so you can replace it with a national value if you have one.



IPCC Tier 2 Cattle GHG Uncertainty Calculator

Approach 2 Monte Carlo · CGIAR Alliance / Bioversity-CIAT · funded by the Global Methane Hub

EN FR

Home | Resources | 1. Data Input | 2. QA/QC | 3. Correlations | 4. Simulate & Results | 5. Sensitivity | 6. IPCC Report | Contact / Feedback

Developed by CIAT/CGIAR Alliance | Funded by Global Methane Hub

Watch this tab explained (1 min)

What to do: After loading data, review these automated quality checks. The tiles count the findings by status and filter the table: click Fail to see every parameter with a failure, open, with the findings that need attention. One row per parameter; open a row to read each finding and its message.

Missing : the parameter was not in your upload and was auto-filled from the IPCC default. Verify or replace with country-specific data.

Fail : the value, its unit or its bounds would break or distort the simulation. Correct it in your Excel file.

Warn : the value is outside its usual range or far from the IPCC default, or the row has no uncertainty. Check it; if it is right, document the source in your inventory QA/QC records (the tool does not store notes).

Info : a note, nothing to correct: a row sampled as a constant because its bounds equal its mean, symmetric bounds where IPCC gives a skewed range, or no Manure_Management sheet.

Pass : check satisfied.

Fix any **Fail** before running: correct the value in your Excel file and upload it again. **Warn** are advisory: document your justification for large deviations from IPCC defaults in your own inventory QA/QC records.

Auto-filled parameters: If any parameters were absent from your upload, an **Auto-filled parameters** panel appears above the results table showing which values were substituted from IPCC defaults. Review these and replace with country-specific data in your template where possible.

QA/QC Results

0 Fail | 1 Warn | 0 Info | 497 Pass | 498 All checks

Click a status to keep only the parameters concerned. One row per parameter: open it to read each finding with its message. Open all / Close all

▶ What is checked

Search:

Parameter	Status	fail	warn	info	pass
BW	△ warn	0	1	0	19
ASH	✓ pass	0	0	0	25
Bo	✓ pass	0	0	0	15
C	✓ pass	0	0	0	15
Ca	✓ pass	0	0	0	15
Cfi	✓ pass	0	0	0	15
Cp	✓ pass	0	0	0	20
CP	✓ pass	0	0	0	20
DE	✓ pass	0	0	0	20
DMI	✓ pass	0	0	0	15
EF3_PRP	✓ pass	0	0	0	20
EF4	✓ pass	0	0	0	20
EF5	✓ pass	0	0	0	20
Fat	✓ pass	0	0	0	20
Frac_GASM_PRP	✓ pass	0	0	0	25
Frac_LEACH_PRP	✓ pass	0	0	0	30
GE	✓ pass	0	0	0	15
hours	✓ pass	0	0	0	15
Milk	✓ pass	0	0	0	15
MilkPR	✓ pass	0	0	0	20
MW	✓ pass	0	0	0	15
N	✓ pass	0	0	0	10
pct_pregnant	✓ pass	0	0	0	23
Tw	✓ pass	0	0	0	10
UE	✓ pass	0	0	0	25

Previous 1 2 Next

19 Correcting a template you already produced

You can change things in two ways.

In the conversation. Click **Back to the conversation (your answers are kept)**, type what should change, and click **Produce template now** again. Your earlier answers stay in place.

In Excel. Correct the data workbook in Excel, go back to the conversation, and use the **Upload a past translation** button above the reply box. Add a note about what you changed. The AI treats the corrected file as the truth and produces the template from it.

20 One inventory per conversation

One conversation makes one template for one country and one year. For a second year or a second country, click **Start a new translation**. Do not continue the old conversation for new data, because the names and units agreed for the first file would be carried over without anyone noticing.

21 If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
The file is refused before upload	It is over 8 MB. Copy the cattle sheets into a new workbook and upload that.
A warning that the file is too big for the conversation	Untick sheets the translator does not need.
A sign-in email does not arrive	Check the spam folder. Use a normal browser window, not a private one.
“Monthly cap reached”	The project’s monthly AI budget is used up. Contact the administrator.
A value in the template is wrong	Go back to the conversation and say which value and what it should be.
The page was closed during production	The three files are emailed to you. They also stay in the app until the server restarts.

22 Your data and the cost

When you upload a file, its contents are sent to the AI service over an encrypted connection. That is how the translation is done. A copy of the conversation, with your data and your email address, is kept on the app server so you can come back to it. **Reset conversation** removes it. The AI service applies its own terms to the data it receives.

The translator is paid for by the project. You are not billed. There is a monthly cap.

Inventory data of this kind is normally not sensitive, because it is reported publicly to the UNFCCC. If your institution does not allow sending data to an external AI service, do not use the translator. Fill the template by hand instead, using the IPCC defaults in the user guide.

22.1 Related material

- User Guide: the whole tool, tab by tab.
- Methodology document: the equations and references behind the template.
- Find out more: Correlations: the correlation modes on the Simulate tab.